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**Philosophy and Current
Issues**

Group 1

6 Musketeers

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Everything Everywhere All At Once



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Table of Contents

1.0 Introduction.....5

2.0 Metaphysics in Everything Everywhere All At Once (EEAO)6

2.1 Concept of Themes6

2.2 The Rise of the Multiverse Concept7

2.2.1 Belief in the Possibility of a Multiverse8

2.2.2 Unbelief in the Possibility of a Multiverse9

3.0 Ideology of Postmodernist Relativism in Everything Everywhere All at Once (EEAAO) 11

3.1 Nihilistic Interpretation 11

3.2 The Origin of “Nothing Matters” 12

4.0 Decolonisation in Everything Everywhere All at Once (EEAAO) 14

4.1 Egoism..... 14

4.2 Analysis of Selfish or Narcissistic Behaviour in the Film..... 16

4.2.1 Moral Perspective 17

4.2.2 Immoral or Emotional Blackmail Perspective 17

5.0 Human Concept in Everything Everywhere All at Once (EEAAO)..... 18

5.1 Analysis of Characters’ Humanity 18

5.2 Agreement with The Film’s Portrayal of Humanity21

6.0 Conclusion22

7.0 References.....23

1.0 Introduction

Everything Everywhere All at Once is a 2022 American absurdist comedy-drama film written and directed by Daniel Kwan and Daniel Scheinert (Mutuc, 2022). The film was produced by A24 and became a cultural phenomenon. It earned seven Academy Awards including Best Picture and made over \$140 million worldwide (Dresden, 2023).

In the film, Michelle Yeoh plays Evelyn Quan Wang, a Chinese-American immigrant who operates a failing laundromat with her passive husband, Waymond, played by Ke Huy Quan (Mutuc, 2022). Evelyn is inundated with several crises, which are a failing business under IRS audit, a marriage in turmoil and a relationship with a depressed daughter, Joy, played by Stephanie Hsu (Mutuc, 2022).

During a tense meeting at the tax office, Evelyn's world turns upside down when she discovers the existence of the multiverse which is a countless number of parallel universes born from every life choice ever made. She learns that a chaotic manifestation called Jobu Tupaki threatens to destroy everything and this failed version of Evelyn may be humanity's only hope. Evelyn connects with alternate versions of herself through verse-jumping to absorb their skills, only to discover that the ultimate villain is none other than her own daughter.

Beyond the film's dazzling visual effects and genre-defying blend of surreal comedy, martial arts cinema and science fiction. The film explores profound philosophical themes which are the anxiety of infinite possibilities, the confrontation with nihilism, generational trauma and ultimately the redemptive power of kindness. As Evelyn traverses multiple universes, the film poses timeless questions to audiences that are, "If everything is possible, does anything matter? And in a meaningless multiverse, what makes life worth living?" These questions resonate deeply in our modern age of infinite choices and constant comparison where social media shows us countless versions of lives we could have lived.

(Written by Amelia Tai)

2.0 Metaphysics in Everything Everywhere All At Once (EEAO)

2.1 Concept of Themes

Everything Everywhere All At Once is a film of boundless imagination that uses the science-fiction concept of the multiverse to discuss the philosophical topics of reality, existence, and free will. The film does not provide a standard answer to whether the multiverse is "right or wrong." Instead, it reveals the complexity and dialectical relationship of these themes through the choices made by the characters amidst infinite possibilities.

The movie defines the concept of the multiverse, where every decision could spawn a new universe, which radically expands our understanding of reality. The multiverse is not just one reality, but a vast "hierarchy of living," where everything happens all at once, at the same time. While some people may not believe in the multiverse, the film uses Evelyn's journey to highlight the infinite possibilities stemming from every decision. This is itself a "new materialism" interpretation of reality, breaking down the binary opposition between mind and matter, soul and material, and showing that reality is composed of materials with infinite possibilities.

Does the multiverse exist? Well, nobody knows. From the movie, we can view two different characters who present two types of nihilism: Jobu Tupaki and Evelyn. Jobu Tupaki presents the negative side of nihilism, which holds that while everything is possible, any decision-making is ultimately meaningless. On the other side is Evelyn, who presents the positive side of nihilism. This view thinks that existence is not something predetermined, but rather something actively constructed through small, present choices such as "love" and "kindness." This contrast is perfectly captured in the iconic scene where they are two silent rocks on a cliffside, existing in stillness, yet choosing to connect.

If the multiverse exists, we could see the end of our destiny, how high we can reach, what we will face, and how to avoid it. In such a world, free will would seem like a joke. However, the film redefines "freedom" precisely within this seemingly radical deterministic framework. For example, Jobu Tupaki, who knows that everything follows a predetermined rule, chooses to give up on existence. But Evelyn is different. Even though she knows this to be true, she still chooses to face it. Even knowing that the essence of the universe is chaos and meaninglessness, she still chooses to embrace life and fight against nihilism with kindness and love. This choice is not about logic, but about belief. Ultimately, the film argues that our freedom lies in this very act of choice, a hopeful message in a seemingly meaningless universe. (The Living Philosophy, 2023)

(Written by Jonsen Choong)

2.2 The Rise of the Multiverse Concept

The multiverse is the concept that there are several universes that coexist concurrently and are all variations of reality, caused by different decisions and events (EBSCO, 2023). Parallel universes imply that each decision sets a new direction in which life will take. The term has become particularly popular over the past few years with the rise in interest in quantum theories, including the many-worlds interpretation, and the popularity of complicated plots in modern film. The multiverse is a good framework to use in contemporary films because more audiences are attracted to films with non-linear storytelling that address issues of identity among one or more realities.

In the movie *Everything Everywhere All at Once*, the multiverse is introduced with the power to verse-jump into other forms of Evelyn Wang. The scenes where Evelyn is shown as a movie star, a skillful Teppanyaki cook, a martial artist, show that life choices can make a person have completely different identities and destinies (Page, 2022). The quick changing of the universes is graphically depicted as a manifestation of the inexhaustibility of opportunities, and the environment of the IRS office is used as the contrast of unprecedented universes and regular existence. These parallel worlds emphasize unfulfilled potential and regret as the core of human life.

In addition to its scientific assumption, the multiverse is used as a metaphor of free will and fate. The idea that every decision is a choice that would lead to a different life is supported by the fact that the film presents several different universes, each of which is its own life. The emotional burden of infinite possibilities resulting in a sense of meaninglessness is captured in Jobu Tupaki's nihilistic worldview that is symbolized by the "everything bagel" (Lee, 2022). Nevertheless, the movie eventually teaches that meaning does not lie in seeking all the possible lives, but in living the current one to the fullest. The movie describes the dilemma of purpose in a world of infinite options and conflicting identities through the multiverse.

(Written By Justin Goh Han Yang)

2.2.1 Belief in the Possibility of a Multiverse



Fig 2.2.1.1 Quantum mechanisms

The assumption that there could be a multiverse is justifiable by rational and empirical arguments based on scientific and philosophical framework. The many-worlds interpretation of quantum mechanics (1957) by Hugh Everett offers a logical explanation of the phenomenon of quantum uncertainty by suggesting that every possible outcome of an event arises in many parallel worlds or branches (Vaidman, 2002). Moreover, the theory of possible worlds by philosopher David Lewis provides a logical metaphysical basis by stating that there are many realities that need to be present to explain modal truths like the possibility and necessity (Weatherson, 2009). All of these frameworks make the multiverse a logically consistent and intellectually viable idea.

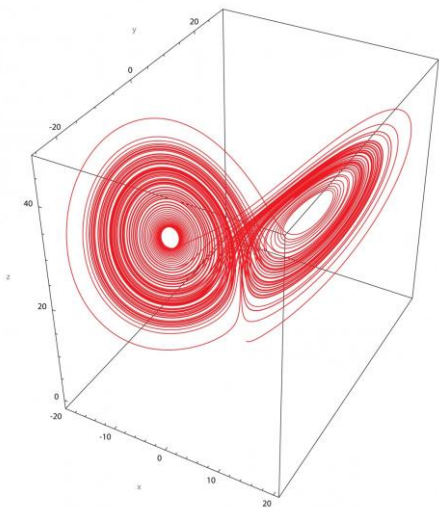


Fig 2.2.1.2 Butterfly Effect

The multiverse, introduced in *Everything Everywhere All at Once*, is a concept that represents both logic and human reality. The fact that Evelyn Wang was able to see other possible lives, including one in which she entered the world of filmmaking or made a career as a chef, illustrates the fact that even subtle choices can result in radically different results. This description is reminiscent of the butterfly effect, which is a concept based on chaos theory; that large-scale occurrence can arise because of small deviations in initial conditions. This concept is overstated in the film to serve the purposes of the narrative, but the logic behind the point is arguably

convincing as the real-life experience always proves that personal decisions influence the course of life dramatically and unexpectedly (Meisels, 2023).

The skeptical viewpoint is that the multiverse is not empirically verifiable and therefore is purely theoretical and not a fact. Nonetheless, skepticism does not debunk the concept rather it strengthens it philosophically and metaphorically. The existential despair that Jobu Tupaki faces in the film, symbolized by the “everything bagel” is the psychological effects of facing limitless possibilities. It is this skepticism that the narrative ultimately overcomes by enforcing that meaning is not a result of establishing that there are several different universes, but a result of emotional connection and deliberate choices to that one reality. Consequently, the multiverse is convincingly introduced as a logical scientific hypothesis and as a metaphor based on human experience, free will and the consequences of choices (Kwan and Scheinert, 2022).

(Written By Justin Goh Han Yang)

2.2.2 Unbelief in the Possibility of a Multiverse

Some of our group members doesn't believe the existence of multiverse is because rational philosophical principles and empirical constraints can be used to substantiate the skepticism of the multiverse theory. A significant argument has been founded on the Occam Razor, which argues that the simplest explanation that needs the least amount of assumptions is usually best. One universe can be used to explain the observable physical phenomena without the need to have an infinite number of unobservable realities. The multiverse theory compounds the entities out of necessity not to say that it cannot be directly empirically proven, but is scientifically speculative and not empirically tested. In such a sense, theoretical consistency is not in itself a validation and explanatory simplicity is a more powerful rational stance (The Interaction Design Foundation, 2016).

The other objection is that of uniqueness of matter and spatiotemporal identity. Classical metaphysics asserts that any existing entity is at a given point in space and time and that it can not exist in more than one state at a time. The concept of different numbers of the same person in different parallel worlds questions the law of numerical identity and poses contradictions in terms of the continuity of the self. In Everything Everywhere All at Once, there are several Evelyns, existent in two or more realities at the same time, but each of them is unique and has no connection with the others, except in the fictional sense of verse-jumping. Although the story is interesting, this duplication is not empirical and does not align with known conceptions of physical matter and the sense of identity (Inwagen, 2026).

Skepticism is also enhanced by religious and cultural views. Most of the traditional belief systems focus on the single linear life that is based on moral responsibility, karma, or the divine purpose. The notion of infinite branching realities has the potential of undermining the importance of individual responsibility since it implies that all possible actions already happen somewhere (Okpala and Ackatz, 2023). The sheer presence of infinite universes in the movie brings about a nihilism of the so-called everything bagel by Jobu Tupaki, which act as a symbol of disillusionment in the face of limitless possibility. This depiction indirectly aligns with skeptical issues: when there

are too many possible results; moral weight and fate will become incoherent. Therefore, the argument against the multiverse is justifiable as a stand that is based on logical simplicity, metaphysical consistency and cultural coherence.

(Written By Justin Goh Han Yang)

3.0 Ideology of Postmodernist Relativism in Everything Everywhere All at Once (EEAAO)

3.1 Nihilistic Interpretation

According to Pratt (n.d.), nihilism is commonly defined as the denial of established meanings or ethical certainties. In contemporary philosophy, it is often brought up when people are confronted with confusion or challenging conventional values. This crisis is presented in *Everything Everywhere All at Once*, in which each decision has infinite possibilities; and no other character exemplified this worldview more than Jobu Tupaki (Johnston, 2025).

Having lived multiple realities at the same time, she comes to the conclusion that nothing matters since everything occurs someplace in the multiverse (Ford, 2022). This viewpoint is in line with the existential concerns of hopelessness, where people are presented with unlimited possibilities. For instance, the “everything bagel” is a visual representation of such a notion as it epitomizes the breakdown of meaning into a void where the distinction between success and failure is lost (Johnston, 2025).

The film also shows why nihilism can seem enticing to certain groups of people, because the principle of nothing matters eliminates the feeling of pressure, expectation, and guilt that resides in personal failure (Pratt, n.d.). For characters who are emotionally drained, nihilism tends to be a coping mechanism that temporarily soothes anxiety, further demonstrating itself as not only an abstract philosophy, but also an emotional reaction to disappointment.

These tendencies are also evident in real-life scenarios, especially in younger generations where nihilistic manifestations are often found on the internet via social media, memes, and even conversations about “existential burnout”, or the idea that personal actions have few lasting effects (Craig, 2019). For instance, economic instability, climate change, and high-level academic or career competition are worldwide problems that have caused certain people to pursue the “nothing matters” mentality as a coping mechanism to manage stress and disappointment (Mucci et al., 2016). These instances highlight that nihilism is not merely a philosophical concept but a contemporary psychological reaction to existential doubts.

These instances highlight that nihilism is not merely a philosophical concept but a contemporary psychological reaction to existential doubts. However, while nihilism may offer temporary relief, the movie ultimately emphasizes its adverse effects. Jobu Tupaki's character is emotionally distant. Jobu Tupaki's character is emotionally distant and fails to form bonds with people. Her failure to seek meaning causes solitude rather than freedom, indicating that nihilism mostly results in despair (Marvel, 2023). This destructive pattern is not limited to fiction; it mirrors real-life psychological outcomes. For instance, consider a child who comes home with high marks on an exam, seeking validation, but instead faces scolding from parents who focus only on the marks that were "lost." When this happens repeatedly, the child may internalize the belief that nothing they do will ever

be good enough, leading to the conclusion that their efforts are ultimately meaningless. This mindset—that trying does not matter because the outcome is always criticism—echoes the same nihilistic despair that consumes Jobu. Hence, the film portrays nihilism as psychologically destructive as it eradicates the importance of human connections and the value of personal effort.

Evelyn's journey provides a contrary response. Despite finding herself lost in the world of multiversal chaos, she eventually begins to give importance to common experiences and relationships. As opposed to being content with meaninglessness, she finds out that meaning can be formed through empathy and conscious decisions (Reid, 2022). This juxtaposition of Evelyn and Jobu depicts the main discussion of the movie: “does meaning have to be objective or can it be constructed subjectively?”.

(Written by: Aqil Zanieal Yeong)

3.2 The Origin of “Nothing Matters”

The notion that all everything is meaningless begs the question as to whether nihilism opposes science or religion, or both. As much as it might seem to contradict these frameworks, the relationship is much more complex.

3.2.1 Nihilism and Science

Science describes the occurrences of nature based on observation and rationality. The multiverse concept presented in the film is based on the concepts of quantum theory and parallel worlds, with scientific imagination as the guiding concept of philosophical exploration (Gribbin, 2020). Nonetheless, science does not dictate meaning or purpose; it explains how the universe operates but not the importance of life (Fiveable, 2025). Thus, nihilism is not scientific but a philosophical connotation (Britannica, 2025).

Within the film, Jobu Tupaki views the existence of multiverses as proof that nothing matters, yet Evelyn counters this by seeking emotional development and closer connections. This opposition demonstrates that science does not necessarily result in nihilism because meaning is subject to individual perception. Science also promotes curiosity and evolution, implying that extensive knowledge can foster interaction, as opposed to hopelessness.

3.2.2 Nihilism & Religion

Religion has long been a source of moral guidance and direction, usually rooted in divine will or spiritual harmony (Elsayed et al., 2023). In this regard, nihilism is incompatible since it denies meaning and moral values. The movie's “everything bagel” is an analogy of a universe deprived of purpose, unlike religious beliefs that place an emphasis on cosmic meaning (Johnston, 2025).

The film however, does not blatantly reject religion. Rather, it underscores the act of kindness, forgiveness, and compassion, which are prevalent in religious and non-religious standpoints (Reecha, 2022). For example, Evelyn's decision to behave empathetically implies that purpose can be found in relationships and moral action. Although nihilism fails to align with some religious beliefs, the general idea of the film fits within common ethical standards.

3.2.3 Is Nihilism Against Both

“Nothing matters” is more of a philosophical reaction to existential doubt than active rejection of science or religion. Science describes reality, whereas religion provides systems of meaning; and nihilism is a conflict between these two perspectives.

The film's plot signals that meaning is formed by choice and human relationships, which is in line with existentialism. By offering various answers to existential crisis, the film does not rely on a single-minded approach towards scientific determinism or religious certainty, but focuses more on a humanistic approach where empathy provides meaning to life.

(Written by: Aqil Zanieal Yeong)

4.0 Decolonisation in Everything Everywhere All at Once (EEAAO)

4.1 Egoism

We often hear that egoism is a choice people make to benefit themselves. However, sometimes egoism is not a conscious choice but a forced response to circumstances. From another perspective, these characters don't always believe what they logically see, instead of they react based on what they feel and have experienced.

In the movie, we see that Evelyn's egoism stems not from malicious self-love, but from a deep self-absorption. She traps herself in regrets about the life she didn't choose, rendering her blind to the life right in front of her. Evelyn uses dismissiveness as a defense mechanism to ignore the needs and perspectives of her family. She overlooks Waymond's heartfelt attempts to communicate, such as when he tries to discuss his feelings about the divorce papers. Similarly, when Joy tries to introduce her girlfriend Becky, Evelyn immediately deflects the conversation. This scene isn't just rudeness; it reflects a narcissistic inability to accept a reality that doesn't fit her worldview. During the laundromat audit, her frantic, stressful behavior leads her to claim charitable deductions for her 'kung fu lessons'—a desperate act of ego-preservation. She is trying to force reality to bend to her will rather than accepting the situation. Furthermore, when Evelyn experiences her alternate lives in the multiverse, she deeply enjoys the glamorous, successful lives she could have had—becoming a movie star or a martial artist. Even in her moment with Waymond, her aspirations are filtered through the lens of regret. Ultimately, she realizes that the ordinary life she has been desperately trying to escape is, from another perspective, the most meaningful one. Her self must traverse the multiverse to understand the value of what has always resided within her. (The Living Philosophy, 2023)

Joy Wang, or Jobu Tupaki, is the most potent symbol of egoism in the film. The more Jobu experiences all of existence simultaneously, the more she becomes paralyzed by the ultimate ego trap: the belief that nothing matters. Her ego has expanded to encompass the entire multiverse, and in doing so, it has collapsed in on itself. The 'Everything Bagel' is her attempt to impose her internal reality—the reality of nihilism and meaninglessness—onto all of existence. This is a pure form of narcissism: 'My pain is so absolute, my truth so universal, that all of reality must be destroyed to reflect it.' Her philosophy is a direct attack on the structures and perspectives of others. By declaring that nothing matters, she invalidates everyone else's struggles, loves, and hopes. She seeks to annihilate the meaning that others create because she cannot find any herself. Her desire for Evelyn to join her in the Bagel is a narcissistic plea for validation: 'See the world the way I do, so I don't have to be alone in my despair.' (Kwan, D. and Scheinert, D., 2023)

While Evelyn and Joy exhibit destructive egoism, Waymond serves as the film's moral opposite, demonstrating that kindness is not weakness. In a traditional sense, Waymond is the least egotistical character; he constantly sacrifices his own happiness for his family. However, the film

cleverly reveals his 'alphaverse' version, where he is a stoic action hero. This version of Waymond admits that in every universe, his one true weakness is that he wants to be kind and see the good in everyone. This is significant because it frames his 'weakness' as a powerful, conscious choice against egoism. He experiences the same multiverse chaos as everyone else, but he chooses empathy over nihilism. His egoism is inverted: instead of bending the world to his will, he bends himself to hold the world together. He forces Evelyn to see that her perception of him as a failure is wrong, and that his gentle way of existing is actually a form of strength. (Kwan, D. and Scheinert, D., 2023)

Gong Gong (Evelyn's father) represents the origin of the egoism that plagues the Wang family. His egoism is rooted in rigid tradition and control. When Evelyn chose to marry Waymond against his wishes, he disowned her, declaring, 'If you go, you are no longer my daughter.' This act of conditional love is profoundly narcissistic; he valued his authority and cultural expectations over his daughter's happiness. This rejection is the foundational wound that created Evelyn's insecurity and her relentless pursuit of validation. In the film, his character is often seen judging Evelyn from his wheelchair, a constant reminder of the critical voice in her head. His narcissism is not about seeking pleasure, but about maintaining a worldview where his rules are absolute. He forces his ego onto his family, and it is only by confronting him and choosing acceptance (with Becky) that Evelyn can begin to heal the cycle.

This pattern of parental egoism is not confined to fiction; it plays out in countless real-life households. Consider a child who has a natural passion for drawing or painting, spending hours lost in creative expression. However, their parents, believing that only "practical" careers lead to success, constantly dismiss this interest, insisting the child focus solely on subjects like science or mathematics. The child is given no choice; their free time is filled with tuition and worksheets, leaving no room for artistic exploration. Over time, the child stops drawing altogether. Their creativity, once a source of joy, becomes suppressed. More damagingly, their thinking becomes limited—they learn that their own interests do not matter and that conformity is the only path to approval. This child, like Evelyn, grows up believing that their authentic self is unacceptable, and that they must mold themselves to fit their parents' rigid expectations. The cycle of egoism continues, passed down not through malice, but through the quiet, persistent force of a parent's unyielding will.

(Written By Jonsen Choong)

4.2 Analysis of Selfish or Narcissistic Behaviour in the Film

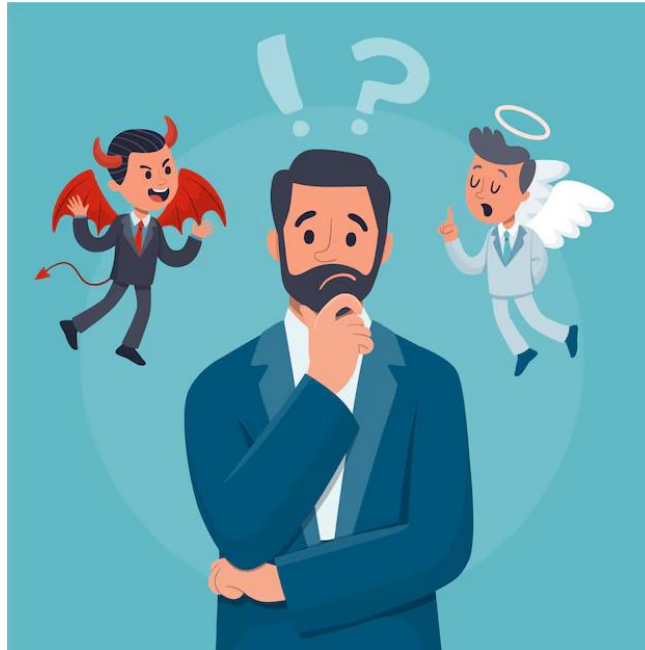


Fig 4.2 Moral or Immoral

In this film, it is understandable that the behaviour of being selfish or narcissistic of the characters is not actually immoral, but is rather an attempt to cope with life. The movie effectively demonstrates that egoism tends to emerge whenever humans feel overwhelmed, stressed, or emotionally exhausted. Personally, the movie describes selfishness as a response to fear and the urge to maintain control in the unpredictable world, instead of simply treating it as self-love or intentional wrongdoing.

To begin with, the actions of Evelyn Wang can be regarded as morally justifiable and partly immoral at the same time. She is usually seen as selfish in the sense that she is more focused on work, money, and survival over the emotional needs of her family. She does not pay enough attention to Joy's feelings and often misunderstands Waymond's kindness but is concentrated mainly on fixing problems in a practical way. However, this behaviour can be greatly influenced by her situation as an immigrant mother who has to manage the problems of financial stress, social expectations, and the fear of failure. From a cultural perspective, parents are often supposed to emphasize financial stability than expressing emotions especially in traditional Asian families. Hence, her behaviour reflects stress and anxiety rather than deliberate negligence, suggesting that her egoism is more forced than voluntary.

Besides, Jobu Tupaki's behaviour can also be labelled as ethically immoral, particularly when she creates the "Everything Bagel" and disregards the emotional and physical consequences on others. Nevertheless, her behaviour is due to hopelessness but not self-obsession. After experiencing countless universes, she loses the ability to find the meaning in relationships and in a single life. So, it is possible that people believe that she is behaving in a selfish way, but in fact, she is emotionally numb and depressed. On the other hand, suffering does not justify having the right to act in ways that harm others or deny their value. Therefore, her nihilistic belief that nothing matters removes moral responsibility and makes her actions ethically unacceptable.

Furthermore, Waymond Wang's kindness is less a purely moral act and more a controversial one. This is because while his gentle attitude helps to promote peace, it may also serve as a way to escape confrontation and responsibility. For instance, Waymond occasionally refuses to directly tackle serious issues within his family by constantly deciding to be nice all the time, causing emotional conflicts to remain unresolved. From a personal viewpoint, kindness should not replace honest communication, as avoiding any form of conflict may unintentionally enable harmful situations to continue.

All in all, the film indicates that egoism in human actions is not always purely moral or immoral. Instead, it often exists in a grey area zone by personal struggles, cultural pressures, and emotional survival, which requires moral judgement to consider both intention and consequences.

(Written by Tan Kai En)

4.2.1 Moral Perspective

From a moral perspective, certain characters in the film make decisions that appear selfish or even narcissistic, yet it is usually based on the intention to protect themselves or others from further harm. To illustrate, the priority of Evelyn Wang towards the work and survival can be viewed as a morally justifiable effort to ensure a better future of her family. Although she fails to provide emotional communication, her decisions are influenced by responsibility but not pure selfishness. Similarly, Waymond's habit of choosing kindness reflects a moral belief that kindness can reduce violence and pain. Even though his actions are imperfect, they are aimed at maintaining family harmony and sustaining relationships. From this perspective, egoistic behaviour in the movie can be justified ethically when it is directed toward long-term stability, peace, or the happiness of loved ones.

(Written by Tan Kai En)

4.2.2 Immoral or Emotional Blackmail Perspective

From an immoral or emotional blackmail perspective, selfish behaviour becomes objectionable when such behaviour is self-centred and harms others. The actions of Jobu Tupaki are a clear example of this, as her nihilistic worldview leads her to impose despair onto others by creating the "Everything Bagel". Not only that, she denies the value of other people's lives and emotions by claiming that nothing matters can be treated as emotional coercion. Moreover, this behaviour also reflects emotional immaturity, as her inability to deal with suffering leads her to generalize her sense of despair and expecting others to consider it as truth.

Last but not least, Evelyn pressuring Joy emotionally to conform to the family's expectations may also be described as immoral, as it involves the use of authority and tradition to control, instead of understanding. According to this approach, egoism is considered unethical in cases of reinforced power, avoiding responsibility, or emotional control of others.

(Written by Tan Kai En)

5.0 Human Concept in Everything Everywhere All at Once (EEAAO)

5.1 Analysis of Characters' Humanity



Fig 5.1.1 Evelyn Quan Wang

Evelyn Spring Wong embodies the human struggle—a mix of discontent, regret, and a yearning for her father's approval. A frantic mother juggling a laundromat, taxes, and family conflicts, she neglects her daughter Joy's emotional needs, even introducing Becky as "just a friend" to prevent Joy from coming out. All this stems from Evelyn's fear that her father will perceive her parenting as unconventional.

When she glimpses other parallel universes, her humanity begins to crumble. In these universes, she didn't marry Wemond or have Joy, yet she achieved success. Faced with these "better" versions of herself, she grows increasingly dissatisfied with her current life, questioning every choice she's made—including leaving her father for Wemond. This despair nearly drives her to swallow Job Tupack's bagel, symbolizing a complete surrender to nihilism.

However, witnessing Wemond's humanity in different universes transforms Evelyn's perspective. His unwavering kindness and compassion reveal hidden beauty within her ordinary life. Evelyn no longer wallowed in regret, but accepted her life and began to confront her fears: she communicated honestly with her daughter Joy and placed her daughter's happiness above her father's approval.



Fig 5.1.2 Waymond Wang

Waymond Wang represents the quiet strength of human kindness and the conscious choice to love despite suffering. In Evelyn's universe, he is the husband who patiently places stickers on luggage even when his efforts are dismissed, who attempts gentle conversations about divorce papers without anger, and who fights to save his marriage through small acts of devotion rather than grand confrontation. His persistence is not weakness but a deliberate expression of care.

In the alphaverse, where he exists as a stoic leader, Waymond reveals that across every version of himself, his "one true weakness" remains the same: he wants to be kind and see the good in people. This admission reframes kindness not as naivety but as a powerful, conscious choice against cynicism and egoism.

Most strikingly, in the universe where Evelyn became a movie star and never married him, an alternate Waymond still carries the same gentle spirit. When he tells her, "In another life, I would have really liked just doing laundry and taxes with you," his words contain no bitterness or regret—only warmth, acceptance, and genuine affection. Across every reality, Waymond consistently chooses empathy, patience, and unconditional love. His humanity lies in this unwavering commitment: bending himself to hold others together rather than demanding the world bend to him.



Fig 5.1.3 Joy Wang/Jobu Tupaki

Joy Wang, the daughter shows another side of human nature as she's a teenager that is looking for acceptance in the world, especially from her mother, Evelyn. Jobu Tupaki experienced every universe all at once which led her to believe nothing truly matters. Therefore, she created the "everything bagel". Instead of going in to it alone, she wants to look for a version of her mother that understand what she's going through and walk through the "everything bagel" with her but instead, Evelyn choose to stay with Joy, rather than allowing Joy to dissapear into the everything bagel and Joy's perspective of humanity change and she starts to believe again when she sees that Evelyn no longer tries to fix, control or hide who Joy is and she will listen and accepts Joy as a whole.

As a family, Evelyn, Waymond, and Joy represent different aspects of humanity, Evelyn being the struggle, regrets and personal growth. Waymond being patient, kind, and believing good deeds will be rewarded, and lastly, Joy, who represents existential doubt and the need for acceptance.

(Written by Yeoh Hao Jie)

5.2 Agreement with The Film's Portrayal of Humanity

Our group members agree that the film *Everything Everywhere All at Once* provides a deep examination of the most complicated and universal aspects of human nature, which is the complexity of love and family relationships. At its foundation, it is full of philosophical questions about the human condition even if it presents itself as a dramatic work of science fiction.

The bonds between Evelyn and her husband Waymond, father Gong Gong and daughter Joy form the film's emotional core. Instead of romanticising family ties, the movie boldly illustrates how love may unintentionally become a source of suffering. In one particularly poignant scene, Evelyn tries to tell Joy, "I want you to be healthy and happy." but what comes out instead is, "You've gained weight again." This moment perfectly captures the disconnect between intention and impact in family communication. As a first-generation immigrant who grew up in a patriarchal household, Evelyn unconsciously repeats the same harsh patterns in raising Joy, thereby demonstrating how generational trauma perpetuates family tragedy. In the Alpha universe, the successful scientist Evelyn pushed her daughter to the point that Jobu Tupaki broke down and transformed her into a chaotic manifestation who desperately seeks her mother's acceptance before destroying her in every universe. This terrible cycle emphasises the universal human need for parental approval and the devastation that follows when it remains unfulfilled.

The film's multiverse premise effectively expresses existential anxiety in today's society. Every choice spawns a new universe where Evelyn can be a famous chef, a martial arts superstar or even a silent rock observing existence. This obsession with "What if" reveals a fundamental lack of meaning in our present lives. Jobu creates the Bagel, a swirling void that embodies her belief that "nothing matters". For Jobu, the Bagel represents not a desire to destroy the universe but to erase herself from existence entirely. Yet in the most ordinary setting, the laundromat universe, Evelyn finally realises that "it's okay that she's a mess" indicates that acceptance doesn't require perfection.

Evelyn resolves the threat of the Bagel through a surprisingly simple philosophy that is to be kind. The film suggests that life itself can be like the Bagel, an empty and seemingly meaningless core. But precisely because of this inherent emptiness, we must fill each moment with kindness. In a universe where nothing inherently matters, the choice to care, to love and to extend compassion becomes the most meaningful act of all. Through its genre-bonding plot, the film makes clear that meaning in our messy, complicated family relationships, whether painful or beautiful; it is not discovered but created, moment by moment, choice by choice, kindness by kindness.

(Written by Amelia Tai)

6.0 Conclusion

Everything Everywhere All at Once is a movie that skillfully explore the complexity of family dynamics, multiverse theory, and human experience while resisting conventional storylines with its important story characters such as Evelyn, Waymond, Joy, and her alternate self Jobu Tupaki, spanning multiple time periods and places. It is important to note that the idea of certain universes being unattainable in the film could be tied into the complexity of the multiverse concept as the “multiverse” is usually portrayed as a vast system of parallel realities, each with its own set of rules and possibilities.

At the same time, the movie emphasizes the human experience of infinite possibilities that we can see through Evelyn and her daughter Joy alongside with Jobu Tupaki where they travel across numerous dimensions, exploring themes of regret, acceptance, and the search for meaning throughout the endless multiverse of what-ifs. The title, “Everything Everywhere All at Once” really fits the movie as the name is really drilled into the story where the movie immerses the viewers by making everything happen in every universe, all at once.

Not only in the movie, but also in real life, we do experience our own version of the multiverse—not through dimension-hopping, but through the countless "what if" moments that haunt our daily lives. We constantly wonder about the paths not taken: the career we abandoned, the person we didn't marry, the words we left unsaid. Like Evelyn, we often trap ourselves in regret, believing that somewhere out there exists a better version of our lives. We also encounter our own "Jobu Tupaki" moments—periods of despair where we question whether anything truly matters, especially when faced with failure, rejection, or the weight of expectations from family and society. Yet, the movie reminds us that, like Waymond, we possess the quiet power to choose kindness and connection even when the world feels chaotic. In a reality where we cannot control everything, we can still control how we treat the people beside us. The film ultimately reflects that meaning is not found in some perfect alternate universe, but constructed here—through small acts of love, acceptance, and the courage to stay present in the ordinary life we already have.

(Written by Yeoh Hao Jie)

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